# PO11Q - Quantitative Political Analysis: From Measurement to Inference

AI Policy

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**This document outlines the module's policy for the use of Artificial Intelligence (AI). Please read it carefully.**

Before I outline the policy let me just ask you this: why have you come to university? Why have you taken this module? The answer to both of these questions is probably (hopefully!) that you wanted to learn something new. A lot of you will have selected this module to gain quantitative skills for employability reasons. You will not learn anything, substantively, methodologically, or in terms of coding if you ask Claude, ChatGPT, or any of the other chat bots out there to write your report or your code for you. Even in the unlikely case that a violation of this policy will elude my detection in the assessment, saving you from a very uncomfortable academic misconduct process, you will not acquire any new skills from this module, and selecting it will have been absolutely pointless. To cite Blackadder, "a strategically shaved monkey" can operate an AI chat. You did not have to come to university for that. If you are aiming for graduate level employment, it is graduate level skills that will get you through the assessment centres, not your ability to chat with Claude. Having said all this, especially in coding the use of AI *can* be incredibly helpful and time-saving. I have therefore opted for a permissive policy that allows you to use AI in certain ways, but not in others.

On PO11Q, you are allowed to use AI models in the following ways:

- You should use AI to supplement your learning, not to replace it. AI can provide valuable insights and explanations, but it should not be your primary source of information.
- Always verify information provided by AI. While AI models can be very accurate, they can also make mistakes. Double-check all facts and figures from reliable sources.
- Research and study themes and issues relating to the module (e.g., conversing with AI to learn more about particular concepts, or statistical methods).
- Use AI to develop your ideas about issues raised in the module, including ideas that you intend to use in assessed work (e.g., using AI to help develop or clarify your understanding of a sampling distribution, or to discuss the conceptualisation approaches of a concept in the literature).
- Use AI to check R code and to debug faulty code.
- A ChatGPT conversation is not a permissible reference in an assessment. But you can ask ChatGPT for the sources of the information it uses in a conversation. Then verify the information and use the original source as a reference.

The primary goal of this module is to develop your analytical skills to become a more critical thinker. AI should be used as a tool to enhance your learning, not as a substitute for your own intellectual effort.

# 1 | Use of AI in the Assessed Report

While it is acceptable to use AI to develop and refine your ideas and understanding of how your concept is conceptualised and measured in the literature, **you are expressly forbidden** from using AI to **write** your assessment.

All assessed work will be screened for AI use using a combination of automated detection tools and manual review. Misuse of AI in violation of this policy will be referred to the academic misconduct committee and may result in penalties ranging from a reduced grade to failure of the assignment, depending on the severity of the offence.

## 2 | Specific examples of the policy

- **"I had a conversation with ChatGPT to find academic articles on autocracy. This helped me to understand the topic better. Was that allowed?"**
  Absolutely fine. This is an excellent way to use AI for research and understanding.

- **"I was a little unclear after the lecture if I understood correctly what a p-value is and asked ChatGPT. Is that OK?"**
  Again, that is absolutely fine. But please don't forget that Flo and Alex are there to help, as well – both in seminars and in office hours.

- **"I had discussions with AI to develop my understanding of genocide. I wanted to see if my understanding of the topic was correct. Some of the ideas we discussed were subsequently used in my essay. Is this acceptable?"**
  Yes, it is. Using AI to develop and refine your ideas is encouraged, as long as the assessment is your own piece of work, and you do not copy/paste answers into your assessment.

- **"I have asked ChatGPT to write me the R code for a ggplot graph. Is that OK?"**
  ChatGPT can be very good at writing R code, and for longer scripts I often use this myself. As you are at the very beginning of learning R, however, try to write the code yourself. This is the only way to learn R, really. It is crucial to find out yourself what works, to make mistakes, and learn how to rectify them. Remember that learning R is like learning a new language with specific grammar and vocabulary. You will not learn how to speak a language by asking ChatGPT to write something in it. Restrict yourself to using AI for checking your code, or to debug it if R throws up an error that you cannot resolve yourself.

- **"While I was writing my essay, I used AI to help me clean up some of the sentences, make suggestions for placeholders, and check my grammar. Is that ok?"**
  No, because then AI would be writing at least some elements of your assessment.

- **"I asked AI to write the conceptualisation section of my essay. Was it ok to do this?"**
  No, this is a breach of the policy and your essay will be flagged for academic misconduct.

- **"I asked AI to generate a 750-word essay on the conceptualisation and measurement of peace. Does this breach the policy?"**
  You are kidding, right?